

Sensitivity in Power BI

Sensitivity labels in Power BI help protect and classify data by applying **Microsoft Purview Information Protection** policies. These labels ensure that sensitive data is handled appropriately, both inside and outside the organization.

1. What is Sensitivity in Power BI?

- Sensitivity labels classify data as **Confidential, Public, Internal, or Highly Confidential**.
 - They **restrict access, encrypt data, and apply compliance policies** when sharing reports and dashboards.
 - Labels can be applied to **datasets, reports, dashboards, and Power BI content**.
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2. How Sensitivity Labels Work?

Applying Sensitivity Labels

- Labels can be applied manually by users or automatically via **Microsoft Purview policies**.
- Applied labels are **persistent**, meaning they stay with the content even if exported to Excel, PowerPoint, or PDF.
- **Example Sensitivity Labels:**
 - **Public** – Open to everyone.
 - **Internal** – For employees only.
 - **Confidential** – Restricted access, encryption applied.
 - **Highly Confidential** – Strictest protection, restricted sharing.

Enforcement of Sensitivity Labels

- **Restrict Sharing** – Prevents external sharing or access.
 - **Apply Watermarks** – Shows a classification message on reports.
 - **Encrypt Data** – Ensures that only authorized users can access the data.
 - **Limit Exporting** – Blocks data export to Excel, PDF, etc.
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3. Where Sensitivity Labels Apply in Power BI?

Power BI Object	Can Have Sensitivity Labels?
Reports	✔ Yes
Dashboards	✔ Yes
Datasets	✔ Yes
Dataflows	✔ Yes
Workspaces	✗ No
Paginated Reports	✔ Yes

4. How to Apply Sensitivity Labels in Power BI?

1. Go to Power BI Service (app.powerbi.com)
2. Open a Report or Dataset
3. Click on **More Options** (⋮) → **Sensitivity Label**
4. Select a **label** (e.g., Confidential, Internal, Public).
5. Click **Apply**

📌 **Note:** Admins can enforce sensitivity labels using **Microsoft Purview Information Protection (MIP)**.

5. Best Practices for Sensitivity in Power BI

- ✔ **Use Clear Labeling Policies** – Ensure all users understand the meaning of each label.
 - ✔ **Train Users** – Educate employees on when and how to apply sensitivity labels.
 - ✔ **Enable Automatic Labeling** – Use Microsoft Purview to detect and apply labels based on data content.
 - ✔ **Monitor Access & Sharing** – Regularly review who has access to sensitive reports.
 - ✔ **Restrict Data Export** – Prevent unauthorized data sharing outside Power BI.
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6. Conclusion

Sensitivity labels in Power BI help secure and classify business data by applying protection rules **across reports, dashboards, and datasets**. They are essential for **data governance, compliance, and security** in organizations handling confidential data.

Would you like help setting up sensitivity labels in Power BI? 🚀